MPS Ltd

Concall Tracker · Q1 FY2027 (quarter ended 30 June 2026) · NSE: MPSLTD · BSE: 532440 · Report prepared 3 Aug 2026

Not investment advice. Do your own due diligence. An AI-generated reading of the company's own earnings-call transcripts and public financials.

1 Snapshot

What the business does: MPS is the invisible back office of the world's academic and scientific publishing industry. Its oldest business is *typesetting* — turning a raw research manuscript into the finished journal article or textbook page, with text, tables, equations and figures correctly laid out for print and screen. On top of that it now runs the **peer-review** paperwork for publishers (managing the process by which other scientists check a paper before publication), **research-integrity checking** (catching fake papers, faked images and "paper mills"), **hosting platforms** publishers rent by subscription to put their journals online (HighWire, DigiCore Pro, THINK365), **education content** for schools and universities including accessibility work (converting learning material into formats blind or deaf students can use), and **corporate training** content. In February 2026 it bought **Unbound Medicine**, a US subscription service selling clinical reference apps to nursing schools, medical schools and hospitals. Practically all revenue comes from outside India.

Measure (consolidated)	Value	What it means in plain words
Market cap	₹4,736 cr	What the whole company is worth on the stock market — a small-cap.
Q1 FY27 revenue	₹224 cr	Sales in the June-2026 quarter, up 20.4% on ₹186 cr a year ago. The strongest first quarter in the company's history.
Q1 FY27 EBITDA	₹77 cr	EBITDA = operating profit before interest, tax and depreciation. Up 53% — more than double the pace of sales. Margin 34.3% against 27.0% a year ago.
Q1 FY27 net profit	₹50 cr	Bottom-line profit after everything, up 43%. Earnings per share ₹29.70, an all-time quarterly high.
FY26 full year	₹768 cr rev ₹236 cr EBITDA	Revenue grew only 5.7% but EBITDA grew 11.8% to a record 30.7% margin. Net profit ₹173 cr, EPS ₹102.11 — the most profitable year ever, on the slowest sales growth in years.
Cash / borrowings (30 Jun 26)	₹138 cr / ₹38 cr	Effectively debt-free. The small borrowing was drawn to buy Unbound Medicine. The business throws off ₹15–18 cr of cash every month.
Return on capital (FY26)	38–39%	For every ₹100 of capital tied up in the business it earns ₹38–39 a year. Exceptionally high — this is an asset-light people-and-software business.
Promoter holding / payout	68.34% / nil	The founding family owns just over two-thirds and has not sold a share in three years. But **for FY26 the Board declared no final dividend at all** — the first break in a long payout record, to fund acquisitions.
Collection days (DSO)	45 days	How long customers take to pay, improved from 51 days at March-end. Tight and getting tighter — a sign of clean revenue.

An important warning about which numbers you are reading. Screener.in's *default* page for MPSLTD shows the **standalone** Indian entity only: FY26 sales ₹438 cr, EPS ₹74.40, P/E 33.0. Management runs and reports the business on a **consolidated** basis including the overseas subsidiaries — HighWire, AJE, Liberate, MPS Europa, Unbound — where FY26 sales were ₹768 cr and EPS ₹102.11, putting the P/E nearer 26. Same gap in the June-2026 quarter: standalone ₹124 cr of sales and ₹41 cr of profit, consolidated ₹224 cr and ₹50 cr. **Every figure in this report is consolidated**, matching the calls. Anyone comparing against Screener's headline page will see roughly 43% less revenue there — that is the offshore half of the business, not a discrepancy.

2 Concall coverage

Screener lists **44 rows** in the MPS concalls section. **26 carry a transcript link, and all 26 were downloaded.** One pair (Nov 2024) is byte-for-byte the same file uploaded twice, so there are **25 distinct documents**: 22 quarterly earnings calls and 3 one-off acquisition calls (E.I. Design, June 2022; AJE, March 2024; Unbound Medicine, February 2026). Twelve were read in depth for this report.

Quarter / event	Call date	Transcript read?
AJE acquisition call	07 Mar 2024	Yes — full read (background)
Q4 & FY24 · Q1 FY25 · Q2 FY25 · Q3 FY25	22 May 2024 · 09 Aug 2024 · 30 Oct 2024 · 23 Jan 2025	Yes — all four read in full (the Q2 FY25 file is the one Screener uploaded twice)

Q4 & FY25	16 May 2025	Yes — full read
Q1 FY26	18 Jul 2025	Yes — full read
Q2 FY26	12 Nov 2025	Yes — full read
Q3 FY26	02 Feb 2026	Yes — full read
Unbound Medicine acquisition	18 Feb 2026	Yes — full read
Q4 & FY26	18 May 2026	Yes — full read
Q1 FY27	**22 Jul 2026**	**Yes — latest call, read cover to cover ★**
13 earlier calls	Jun 2021 – Jan 2024	Downloaded and available; not deep-read (outside the 2½-year window)

Coverage caveat — the honest version. Of the 44 concall rows Screener holds, **18 have no transcript at all** — only a slide deck. Those are Oct 2021 and every row from Jan 2021 back to Oct 2017 (Jan 2021, Nov 2020, Aug 2020 ×2, May 2020 ×2, Jan 2020, Oct 2019, Jul 2019, May 2019 ×2, Jan 2019, Oct 2018, Jul 2018, May 2018, Jan 2018, Oct 2017). MPS only began publishing transcripts in mid-2021, so those calls happened but **cannot be read** — a genuine gap, not a scraping failure. Every one of the 26 rows that does carry a transcript was obtained and checked. The analysis below rests on the twelve documents above, with the five FY26 calls plus the Q1 FY27 call read line by line.

★ Latest concall highlights — Q1 FY27 (call held 22 July 2026)

- **Sales up 20%, profit up 53%, headcount up under 3%.** Revenue ₹224.24 cr against ₹186 cr; EBITDA ₹76.96 cr against ₹50 cr, taking the margin from 27.0% to 34.3%; net profit ₹50.39 cr, up 43%; EPS ₹29.70. The CFO's own framing: "Revenue grew 20 percent. EBITDA grew 53 percent. Headcount rose less than 3 percent." That is operating leverage — more work pushed through roughly the same number of people.
- **All three divisions expanded margin at the same time.** Research Solutions ₹123.23 cr, +13.2%, margin **45.1%** (core excluding the AJE reset grew 26.3%). Education Solutions ₹73.41 cr, +42.2%, margin 35.1%. Corporate Learning ₹27.60 cr, +6.9% but EBITDA +60.7% and margin from 16.9% to 25.3% — its **second consecutive quarter of growth** after a year of shrinking.
- **The FY27 target was reaffirmed as a floor, not a hope.** "We continue to expect the Company to comfortably cross INR 300 crores in EBITDA in FY'27... read that number the way we read it internally, as a floor rather than a ceiling." Against FY26's ₹236 cr that is a ~27% jump, and Q1's ₹77 cr is slightly ahead of a straight-line path. The longer target is unchanged: ~₹1,500 cr revenue and ~₹450 cr EBITDA by FY28.
- **Unbound Medicine passed its first full quarter.** Running at about USD 800,000 a month at 18–20% margin, and it lifted the billed-client count from 404 to 841 in a year by adding a long tail of medical and nursing schools that renew every year. The CEO: "it proved the thesis rather than the pitch... None of our anchor relationships is billing less."
- **AI is pitched as a tailwind, with a specific reason.** "As models get stronger, the constraint moves away from generating content and toward verifying it... That last mile is exactly where MPS sits." The company also says the revenue model itself is shifting from being paid for hours and pages to being paid for outcomes — 25% of revenue is now outcome-based and 45% is recurring. Cash ₹138 cr, borrowings ₹38 cr, no dividend news; the acquisition pipeline stays open with a stated appetite for a ₹300–500 cr deal funded by cash plus debt, "no equity play here."

2b. Business mix, clients and capacity (Q1 FY27). By division: Research Solutions ₹123 cr = 55% of revenue at a 45.1% margin — the anchor, and the most profitable part. **Education Solutions ₹73 cr = 33%** at 35.1% — the fastest grower and now clearly the second pillar. **Corporate Learning (Liberate Global) ₹28 cr = 12%** at 25.3% — the smallest and, until two quarters ago, the broken one. *Plain read: two engines are firing hard and the third has stopped bleeding.*
Organic versus bought-in: strip out AJE, which is deliberately being shrunk, and revenue grew **28.4% to ₹198.47 cr** with EBITDA up 50.5%. Strip out Unbound as well and an analyst on the call put underlying organic growth in "the early teens" — management did not dispute it, and the CEO conceded the ambition is "late teens" and "we're not settling for achieved organic growth." *Plain read: the headline 20% is roughly two-thirds organic, one-third acquisition. Real, but not all self-generated.*
Geography: North America around 50%, Asia-Pacific roughly 30%, the UK and Europe the rest. India domestic is immaterial — this is an export business earning in dollars. AJE's revenue is ~70% China-sourced.
Clients: 841 billed clients, up from 404 a year ago (all of that jump is Unbound's institutional subscribers), and down from 906 in the prior quarter because AJE is pruning unprofitable accounts. Concentration is still real on the traditional side: the **top 15 customers were 58% of revenue** when last disclosed (May 2025), and MPS has **not repeated that figure since**. Two of the world's largest publishers sit in its top five. **45% of revenue is recurring and 25% is outcome-based**; platform/hosting revenue was 28.6% of the total when last quantified in May 2025 and has not been updated.
Capacity: no factory here — capacity is people plus software. Group headcount is roughly 3,000–3,300 and rose under 3% year on year: Research 2,262 → 2,452, Education 799 → 765, Corporate Learning down about 33% after last year's

restructuring. MPS Labs, the in-house AI engineering unit, is about 200 engineers. **No utilisation percentage is disclosed, and none would be meaningful here** — the equivalent metric is revenue per head, and it is rising sharply.

★ 3. Earning-trigger thesis

Management's case, unchanged for two years, is that MPS is converting from a low-margin production shop paid by the page into an "AI-first knowledge solutions" company paid for outcomes, serving three markets where publishers and universities are consolidating their suppliers down to a handful of scaled vendors. The proof offered is arithmetic rather than narrative: **in Q1 FY27 revenue rose 20% while EBITDA rose 53% and headcount rose under 3%**, with margin expanding in all three divisions at once. On top sits a deliberate acquisition machine — ten deals in twelve years — pointed at **₹300 cr+ of EBITDA in FY27 organically** and **~₹1,500 cr of revenue by FY28**. The trigger is live and already in the numbers. What it is not yet is self-sustaining at the promised pace: organic growth is low-to-mid teens, and the FY28 target needs ₹300–500 cr of unsigned deals.

Trigger	What management said	Evidence so far	Horizon	Strength
Research core compounding	Move up from typesetting into peer-review administration, research-integrity checking and subscription platforms at ~40% + margins; "we sit at the layer where AI cannot afford to be wrong."	Core Research excluding AJE grew **26.3%** in Q1 FY27; segment margin 45.1% against 41.6% in Q4. FY26 organic Research growth was 17%, and pre-acceptance peer-review services grew over 90%. Delivered, repeatedly.	Now → FY28	**Strong** The single most reliable line in the company.
Education scale-up	School and university content, accessibility and translation, all AI-assisted; Unbound bolted on to add recurring subscriptions.	FY26 revenue +36% (+29% organic); accessibility revenue roughly tripled. Q1 FY27 +42.2% at 35.1% margin. Clients now pay MPS to quality-check *their* AI-generated teaching material — a service that did not exist a year ago.	Now → FY28	**Strong** Fastest-growing pillar, and margins rose with it.
Operating leverage, and the ₹300 cr FY27 target	AI and automation let the same team handle more work, so margins expand as revenue grows. Formalised as: "comfortably cross INR 300 crores in EBITDA in FY'27... It's organic," to be read as "a floor, not a ceiling."	Group EBITDA margin went 27.0% → 34.3% in a year on under 3% more people; FY26 was a record 30.7% and Q1 FY27 beat it by 3.6 points. Q1's ₹77 cr annualises to ~₹308 cr *before* the seasonally stronger second half. Not a forecast — an outcome, though it still needs a 27% step-up over FY26.	Now → FY27	**Strong** Already banked, and ahead of the straight line.
Acquisition engine (incl. the AJE reset)	Buy sticky, recurring, high-stakes-content assets with >USD 15m revenue and 5–15% margins, then lift them to 30%; ₹300–500 cr of deals fundable from ₹138 cr cash plus ~₹200 cr of debt, "no equity play." AJE meanwhile is shrunk to its profitable core, then set to "grow on value rather than volume."	The *margin* record is genuinely excellent — HighWire and AJE both travelled from about −5% to 30%+. The *revenue* record is not: AJE has fallen from USD 20m to 12m and was still "resetting by design" in Q1 FY27; Unbound was flat for three years before purchase and is guided roughly flat now. Pipeline of 35 targets with 5 advanced, but only one deal closed in two years, and it was smaller than the stated floor.	FY27 → FY28	**Moderate** Excellent at fixing margins, so far unproven at buying growth.
Corporate Learning turnaround	Merge three legacy entities into one "Liberate Global" brand, cut structure not capability, pivot to AI-enabled and immersive enterprise learning; steady state 30% margin and ~12% growth.	FY26 revenue fell 16.5%. But Q4 FY26 (+2.4%) and Q1 FY27 (+6.9%) were both positive, and margin went 16.9% → 25.3% on a third fewer staff. The turnaround finally arrived — roughly four quarters later than first promised, and growth is still below the 12–13% market rate.	FY27+	**Moderate** Upgraded from broken to healing. Not yet proven.

4 Management consistency scorecard

Period	What was promised	What actually happened	Verdict
Mar 2024 (AJE deal call)	AJE bought from Springer Nature for **USD 8.4m cash** (Springer had paid ~USD 55m). Promise: "enter FY'25 in the early teens in terms of EBITDA margin and exit the financial year in the late 20s, or early 30s... We are aiming for 12 months." Raised in Aug 2024 to "closer to 40%."	The 12-month version missed: AJE was at "late 20s" in Jan 2025 and finished FY25 at **21.7%**, nowhere near 40%. But it kept climbing — 23.7% then 30.2% during FY26, and above 30% since. **The promise was delivered about a year late and the 40% version never at all.** Revenue meanwhile fell from USD 20m to 12m.	**Delivered late**
Mar 2024 → Feb 2026	A second acquisition "north of $20 million in revenue" within "6 to 8 months." Re-promised in Nov 2025 as "5 deals lined up back-to-back" and ₹300–400 cr of acquisitions over 12–18 months, closing "one this financial year... possibly even 2."	Slipped to "end of calendar 2024," then "end of FY25," then "hope to report next quarter," then in Jan 2025: "We still haven't concluded one yet." The deal that finally closed was Unbound in **February 2026 — about 23 months late, and at USD 16.5m on ~USD 9m of revenue it was well inside the ₹300–400 cr envelope and below the stated size floor.** Exactly one of the five closed.	**Missed on time and on size**
May 2024 (Q4 FY24)	"We are comfortable forecasting at least a **25% year-on-year growth in earnings in FY'25**."	They stopped defending it mid-year when H1 profit came in flat, and formally renounced short-term guidance in Jan 2025 — yet the number itself **landed**: consolidated net profit went ₹119 cr → ₹149 cr, up 25.2%. Right answer, badly communicated.	**Delivered**
May 2025 (Q4 FY25)	Corporate Learning turnaround complete "by Q1 [FY26]" with growth "through Q2." The divisional head, twice: "we are confident that **Q2 will see a 20% revenue expansion**." The CEO backed her: "that takeoff is imminent. They have formal commitments and can see it."	The 20% never came: Corporate Learning revenue *fell* every quarter of FY26, finishing down 16.5%, and its share of group revenue went from 17.2% to 11.3%. The promise was never revisited, only recast as "a stutter," and the turnaround slid — "one quarter behind" (Jul), then "from FY'27 onwards" (Nov). Growth finally arrived in Q4 FY26, about four quarters late, with the margin repair better than promised.	**Missed on the number; delivered late on the turnaround**
Jul 2025 (Q1 FY26)	"So next quarter, **we'll also give guidance for FY'26**." Said explicitly, unprompted.	November 2025: "we decided not to give guidance... No thumbs up, thumbs down, no guidance at all." One quarter later, when Q3 disappointed, they *did* issue guidance (EPS above ₹100). Guidance appears when it helps and disappears when it does not.	**Broken**
Feb 2026 (Q3 FY26)	"MPS is comfortably placed to **surpass an EPS of INR 100 in FY'26**" — given in the middle of a weak quarter, when analysts openly doubted it.	FY26 EPS came in at **₹102.11**. The one hard, checkable number they put on the table in two years, and they hit it.	**Delivered**
Feb 2026 (Unbound call)	On the acquisition: revenue "9 million becomes 18 million very quickly... doubling over the next few years"; margin to "early 20s" by the second quarter and "closer to 30%" by Q4 FY27. Also: "capital distribution in the form of dividends or buybacks will continue for the foreseeable future."	Three months later the revenue guide was walked back to USD 750–950k a month — roughly USD 9–11m a year, barely above the USD 8.9m base. Q1 FY27 actual: USD 800k a month at 18–20% margin, not "early 20s." And the Board then declared **no final dividend at all** for FY26.	**Walked back**
May 2026 (Q4 FY26)	"Comfortably cross INR 300 crores in EBITDA in FY'27... It's organic... already in flight, not a step change we are asking you to believe."	Q1 FY27 delivered ₹76.96 cr against a straight-line need of ₹75 cr, with the historically stronger half still to come. Reaffirmed in July 2026 as "a floor." Too early to score, but ahead of pace.	**On track**
Every call Aug 2024 → Jul 2026	"Vision 2027": ~**₹1,500 cr revenue by FY28** at similar margins, later paired with ~₹450 cr of EBITDA. Reaffirmed verbatim on every single	FY26 finished at ₹768 cr — almost exactly the "halfway by FY25" milestone they set. But reaching ₹1,500 cr in two more years needs roughly 40% a year against organic growth in the	**At risk**

	call for two years without a wobble, and honestly labelled from the start as "60% acquisition, 40% organic."	low-to-mid teens, so it rests on ₹300–500 cr of deals that have not been signed. They have never hidden this; they have also never yet closed a deal of that size.

Narrative drift. The strategic story has genuinely not moved. Three markets — Research, Education, Corporate Learning — restated on every call since July 2025; the same "AI-first, trusted knowledge" framing; the same ₹1,500 cr FY28 destination; the same buy-fix-integrate playbook. There has been no pivot into anything unrelated. Where the drift shows is one layer down. **Forecasts get revised faster than they get tested:** the divisional mix was guided at 40:40:20 in February 2026 and 55:35:10 three months later — to their credit the CEO pre-emptively flagged it ("a few years ago, a similar split forecast was made, and we were completely wrong"). **The financing plan has wandered too**, though in the shareholder's favour: a QIP (institutional share sale) resolution was put in place in May 2025 for a ₹300–700 cr deal, then dropped by November — "I don't see it happening in the near future, to be completely blunt" — for cash plus roughly ₹200 cr of debt. Unbound was duly funded with ₹42 cr of borrowing and no dilution. **Leadership turns over unusually fast:** the CFO of eight years simply vanished from the panel between August and October 2024 with no announcement; the CTO who presented in May 2025 was gone by July; a Chief Operating Officer joined in July 2025 and had left by May 2026; a Corporate Learning President appointed in October 2025 was demoted to an SVP-led structure by May 2026; the Q1 FY27 call introduced yet another first-timer. Five senior faces in eight quarters, while the CEO told the May 2026 call "the leadership team is steadier." **Disclosure is inconsistent:** client concentration has been quoted as "top 15 under 60%," "top 10 under 45%," "top 10 at 48%," then "top 15 at 58%" — the definition moves — and has not been given at all since May 2025; platform revenue share (28.6%) is likewise unrepeated; headcount was 3,263 in July 2025 and 3,071 in November with no reconciliation. **And the AI product names multiply faster than revenue is attached to any of them.** Against all that sits genuine candour: they called Q3 FY26 a shock and "pulled the Andon Cord," called Corporate Learning's FY26 "a reset," and invoked a Warren Buffett letter about owning mistakes. This is a team that tells you the truth about the past and is unreliable about the next ninety days.

5 Bottom line — two verdicts

Durable earning trigger? → YES

This is no longer a thesis waiting for evidence; the evidence arrived in the June quarter. Revenue up 20%, EBITDA up 53%, headcount up under 3%, and margin expanding in *all three* divisions at once — that combination cannot be manufactured by accounting or by one lucky contract. The engine is real and specific: MPS has moved from being paid by the page to being paid for outcomes (25% of revenue) and for subscriptions that renew (45%), which is why 20% more sales dropped 53% more profit. Research, the biggest half, grew its core 26% at a 45% margin; Education grew 42%; even Corporate Learning, dead a year ago, has grown two quarters running with margin up eight points. AI — the obvious thing to fear here — is measurably working *for* them: the bottleneck in scientific publishing has moved from producing content to verifying it, and verification is exactly what MPS sells. The business is cash-rich (₹138 cr plus ₹15–18 cr a month), near debt-free, and earns 38%+ on capital. **Two things stop this being a slam dunk:** strip out acquisitions and organic growth is only low-to-mid teens — the CEO himself conceded it should be "late teens"; and the FY28 target of ₹1,500 cr is arithmetically unreachable without ₹300–500 cr of unsigned deals. The trigger is durable. The *pace* management has promised is not yet.

Management consistent? → MAYBE

Split the record in two and it reads very differently on each side. On **the big picture and the hard numbers**, they are good: the ₹1,500 cr FY28 destination has been repeated without a wobble on every call for two years, and honestly labelled from the outset as 60% acquisition-dependent; the one specific, checkable number they staked themselves on — EPS above ₹100 in FY26, given while a weak quarter had analysts doubting them — came in at ₹102.11; FY25's promised 25% earnings growth landed at 25.2% even after they had stopped defending it; the AJE and HighWire margin turnarounds did what was advertised. On **anything with a date inside twelve months**, they are not: the "20% in Q2" was flatly missed, the promise to publish FY26 guidance was abandoned one quarter after making it, the Corporate Learning turnaround slid roughly four quarters, the second big acquisition promised within "6 to 8 months" took 23, Unbound's revenue was going to "double very quickly" and was walked back to flat within three months, and dividends were going to continue "for the foreseeable future" right up until the Board cancelled them three months later. Add five senior leaders rotating off the call panel in eight quarters and disclosures that appear once and vanish, and the picture is a capable, unusually honest operator who is chronically over-optimistic about timing. **Judge them on the year, never on the quarter.** What would move this to a clear yes: FY27 actually landing above ₹300 cr of EBITDA, organic growth reaching the late teens the CEO himself named, and one acquisition that adds revenue growth rather than just repaired margin.

Sources: MPS Ltd earnings-call and acquisition-call transcripts filed with BSE/NSE and sourced from Screener.in — 07 Mar 2024 through 22 Jul 2026, including the AJE (7 Mar 2024) and Unbound Medicine (18 Feb 2026) acquisition calls; Screener.in consolidated and standalone financial history (profit & loss, balance sheet, cash flow, ratios, quarterly results, shareholding), retrieved 3 Aug 2026. All figures quoted are *consolidated*, management's own basis — see the standalone-versus-consolidated warning under Section 1.